



Day 17 · Thursday, Sep 4, 2026 · ROTTERDAM + DELFT + THE HAGUE (self-guided)

Prepared for Divyansh · Pure-Vegetarian Edition · Europe 2026



Solo · Pure vegetarian (no meat, no fish, no seafood, egg avoided) **Base:** Amsterdam (bags stay at the hostel — you return to Amsterdam tonight for your last night). **No flight today** → relaxed.

⚠ The booked group tour was cancelled — this is the self-guided train version, and it's honestly better: three cities south of Amsterdam, all on the same rail line. Route = furthest first (Rotterdam), then work back north (Delft → The Hague → Amsterdam). **Chase the tour refund** — cancelled by the operator = you're owed it.

Book first

- **Mauritshuis** (The Hague) — mauritshuis.nl, ~€19, grab a **~15:00 timed slot**. This is THE highlight of the day. Everything else is walk-in.

FINAL ITINERARY — priority-ranked

Time	Pri	Where / What
~9:15		Amsterdam Centraal → Rotterdam (~40 min direct intercity)
10:00–12:15		 ROTTERDAM
		Markthal (striking market hall + veg lunch) → Cube Houses (Kubuswoningen) → Erasmus Bridge
		Delfshaven (17th-c canal district that survived WWII bombing) <i>or</i> Euromast view — only if ahead of schedule
12:20		Rotterdam → Delft (~13 min)
12:35–14:10		 DELFT (Vermeer's hometown — centre is walkable in 10 min)
		Markt + Nieuwe Kerk (1496; climb the 108 m tower for views), Oude Kerk (1246 — Vermeer is buried here), canal stroll along Oude Delft + backstreets (Vrouwenregt)
		<i>Skip the Royal Delft factory tour (eats 45+ min). Prinsenhof Museum is closed for renovation till 2027.</i>
14:15		Delft → Den Haag (~12 min)
14:45–17:00		 THE HAGUE
		Mauritshuis 15:00  — the real Girl with a Pearl Earring + Rembrandt + Vermeer's View of Delft (~1.5h)
		Peace Palace (Int'l Court of Justice — "The Hague's most photographed building") + Binnenhof exterior only (under renovation)
~17:15		Den Haag → Amsterdam (~50 min) — back ~18:15
evening		Last night in Amsterdam — nice veg dinner, easy pack for tomorrow's flight

 If the day runs short — cut in this order

1. Keep **Mauritshuis** (The Hague) — unmissable, the reason to go
2. Keep **Delft old town** — most charming, and quick
3. Keep **Rotterdam** icons (Markthal + Cube Houses + Erasmus Bridge)
4. Drop the  s first: **Delfshaven / Euromast / Peace Palace / Scheveningen**

TRANSPORT

- All three cities are on the main line **south of Amsterdam** — trains every ~10–15 min, so slippage is easy to absorb.

- **Tap OVpay** (contactless card/phone) in AND out at each station — no paper tickets needed. ~€30–40 round trip for the day.
 - Within Rotterdam: metro/tram, or just walk (sights cluster centrally); a **2-hour local ticket is €5**, day €11.
 - Bags stay at the Amsterdam hostel — you explore all day **bag-free**.
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VEGETARIAN FOOD

- **Rotterdam — Markthal** (lunch): food stalls under the arched hall — falafel, wood-fired veg pizza, Indian, Dutch cheese, fresh juices. **Fenix Food Factory** is a good backup.
 - **Delft — Lunchroom Leonidas** (Choorstraat) + cafés around the Markt.
 - **The Hague / Amsterdam** — plenty; use **HappyCow**. Save appetite for a good last-night veg dinner back in Amsterdam.
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TIPS

- **No flight today, no luggage** → this is a relaxed day; if you love a city, linger.
 -  **Watch the bike lanes** (red pavement) in every Dutch city — cyclists have priority and move fast.
 -  **Chase the cancelled-tour refund** with the operator/WanderOn.
 - Today is a **Thursday** — no Sunday museum closures to worry about.
 - Keep **tomorrow (Sep 5) light** — it's your fly-home day (evening flight from Schiphol). Pack tonight.
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Movies, Songs & Pop Culture Here (Bollywood + Hollywood)

- **Girl with a Pearl Earring (2003)** ★ — Scarlett Johansson & Colin Firth; **Johannes Vermeer's Delft** is the setting. Today is the perfect bookend: you walk **Vermeer's town** and stand at **his grave in the Oude Kerk**, then meet **the actual painting** at the Mauritshuis a few train-minutes later — plus his *View of Delft*, painted from the very canals you strolled.
 - **The Hague** — the seat of international justice (Peace Palace / ICJ) features in countless political dramas and documentaries.
 - **Rotterdam** — its ultra-modern skyline (Cube Houses, Erasmus Bridge, Markthal) is a favourite of architecture films, music videos and ad shoots; the city was rebuilt bold after WWII.
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✅ Verified against Wikivoyage (Delft, Rotterdam) + holland.com (The Hague), Sept 2026 — corrections applied: Binnenhof under renovation (exterior only), Prinsenhof closed till 2027, Royal Delft tour skipped for time, Delfshaven + Peace Palace added.

🎬 Film-location thread runs through the trip · full repo: github.com/divyanshh/trip